Millions of Kids Now Have Trump Accounts

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The U.S. **Treasury Department** has made a Trump Account for every child who can have one. More than 60 million children were signed up automatically. About seven million more were already signed up by their parents after the program began in July.

A Trump Account is a kind of **investment** account. Money in it can grow for many years, and later it becomes a savings account for when a person **retires**.

There are also new rules. **Donors** can now give shares of single companies, called **stocks**. Families cannot pick or refuse these **stocks**, and they must keep them for five years. Before, the money only went into funds that hold small pieces of many companies.

The Treasury says the changes will bring in more gifts and help children from families with less money. Reporter Richard Rubin said the new rules are totally different from the first plan. Some experts have concerns about the stock rules.

Word Treasure

Treasury Department -- The part of the U.S. government that manages the country's money.

investment -- Money put into something so it can grow over time.

retires -- Stops working, usually when a person is older.

Donors -- People or groups who give money or gifts.

stocks -- Small shares that make you a part owner of a company.

Background you need

A Trump Account is a savings and investment account that the U.S. government opens for a child.

Money in an investment account can grow over many years, so starting when you are young can help.

Before this, parents had to sign their kids up, but now the government did it automatically for more than 60 million children.

Break it down

WHO: The U.S. Treasury Department and more than 60 million children
WHAT: Kids were automatically given Trump Accounts, and new rules let donors give stocks
WHERE: Across the United States
WHY: The Treasury says the changes bring in more gifts and help kids from families with less money

Why it matters

Many kids reading this may already have an account with their name on it that could grow until they are grown up.

Test what you remember

1. How many children were signed up for Trump Accounts automatically?

- (A) About 5,000
- (B) More than 60 million
- (C) Exactly 7
- (D) About 100

2. When did the program begin?

- (A) In July
- (B) In December
- (C) Last year in May
- (D) In January

3. What does a Trump Account later become?

- (A) A school lunch card
- (B) A video game account
- (C) A library card
- (D) A savings account for when a person retires

4. What can donors now give to the accounts?

- (A) Books
- (B) Houses
- (C) Stocks, which are shares of single companies
- (D) Toys

5. How long must families keep the donated stocks?

- (A) One month
- (B) One week
- (C) Forever
- (D) Five years

6. Who said the new rules are totally different from the first plan?

- (A) A bank
- (B) A teacher
- (C) Reporter Richard Rubin
- (D) The president

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: D 4: C 5: D 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Treasury Department: Says the changes will bring in more gifts and help children from families with less money.

2. Some experts: Have concerns about the stock rules.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):